

Derek Staley

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Summary

Delivery and program leader with 13 years across tech, games, and enterprise. I've launched new products and verticals and kept cross-functional teams aligned through complex roadmaps. Now I've built two products of my own. Case studies available at dcstaley.github.io

Independent Product Development

Unified Tasks & Habits App | Personal Project, 2026 – Present · productivity-app-five-eta.vercel.app (desktop only)

A local-first productivity app where tasks, habits, and calendar events live in one place.

- Owned the PRD, user stories with acceptance criteria, a competitive analysis, and the information and technical architecture, versioned and kept current as the build proceeded
- Shipped v1 in three phases covering flexible scheduling, habit tracking, tags, notes, completion history, Google Calendar sync, and week and month views. v2 in development, adding analytics, reminders, and richer habit goals

Roster Optimizer for Out of the Park Baseball | Personal Project, 2025 – Present

An analytics and optimization web app for a baseball simulation video game.

- Diagnosed v1's failure with a file-by-file audit (scores computed two different ways), then rebuilt around a single scoring core so the same player is always valued the same way everywhere in the app
- Made the prediction model a swappable component and let a bake-off on real season outcomes choose it, retiring "match the old app's scores" as the goal once the data-trained model won. Live in competitive play

Selected Professional Work

Producer, Demiurge Studios

2023 – 2025

- Worked with Riot's product and design leads on Teamfight Tactics and 2XKO, turning their product direction into plans the dev team could build against, with clear scope and acceptance criteria
- Managed the backlog for Demiurge's cross-functional team, prioritizing work against Riot's direction and what engineering and design could deliver on schedule
- Used delivery data to surface risks early and give studio and client leadership what they needed to make prioritization calls

Program Manager, MGM Resorts International

2021 – 2023

- Stood up delivery for a newly formed product team from scratch, building out the workflow, backlog, and tooling they ran on
- Worked with the Lead Product Manager on roadmap and prioritization, and with finance on staffing and budget

Senior Project Manager, The Zebra

2019 – 2021

- Led the launch of the company's home insurance product, its first move beyond auto insurance
- Set up the delivery practices and reporting the team relied on as it scaled

Agile Project Manager, Confluence Inc

2017 – 2019

- Led the dev support team, balancing client requests against planned development work
- Moved a 20-year-old engineering org onto modern agile practices

Project Manager, Ellation (Crunchyroll)

2016 – 2017

- Led the launch of VRV, a new streaming platform that hit its target launch date as a simultaneous release on iOS, Android, Xbox One, and PS4
- Kept the critical path and blockers visible to engineering and execs, so the team could make scope calls early instead of at the deadline

Project Manager, Big Fish Games

2015 – 2016

- Ran planning and live updates for a top-10 grossing mobile game, working with development, product, QA, and marketing

Project Manager, Branding Brand

2013 – 2014

- Managed delivery for client teams and launched the company's first international travel site

Associate Product Manager, Kixeye

2011 – 2013

- Worked with game design, engineering, and UX to build and ship new game features

Skills

Product: Product Management, Product Roadmapping, Feature Prioritization, Product Discovery, PRDs, User Stories & Acceptance Criteria, Competitive Analysis

Delivery: Backlog Management, Agile, Scrum, Kanban, Jira, Confluence, Program Management, Project Management

Leadership & Collaboration: Cross-functional Leadership, Stakeholder Management, Executive Communication, Team Mentorship

AI & Data: AI-Directed Development, Generative AI, Prompt Engineering, Claude Code, Data Analysis

Certifications: Certified Scrum Master (CSM)

Education

B.S., Information Science and Technology — Penn State University